

Differentiating ODDs

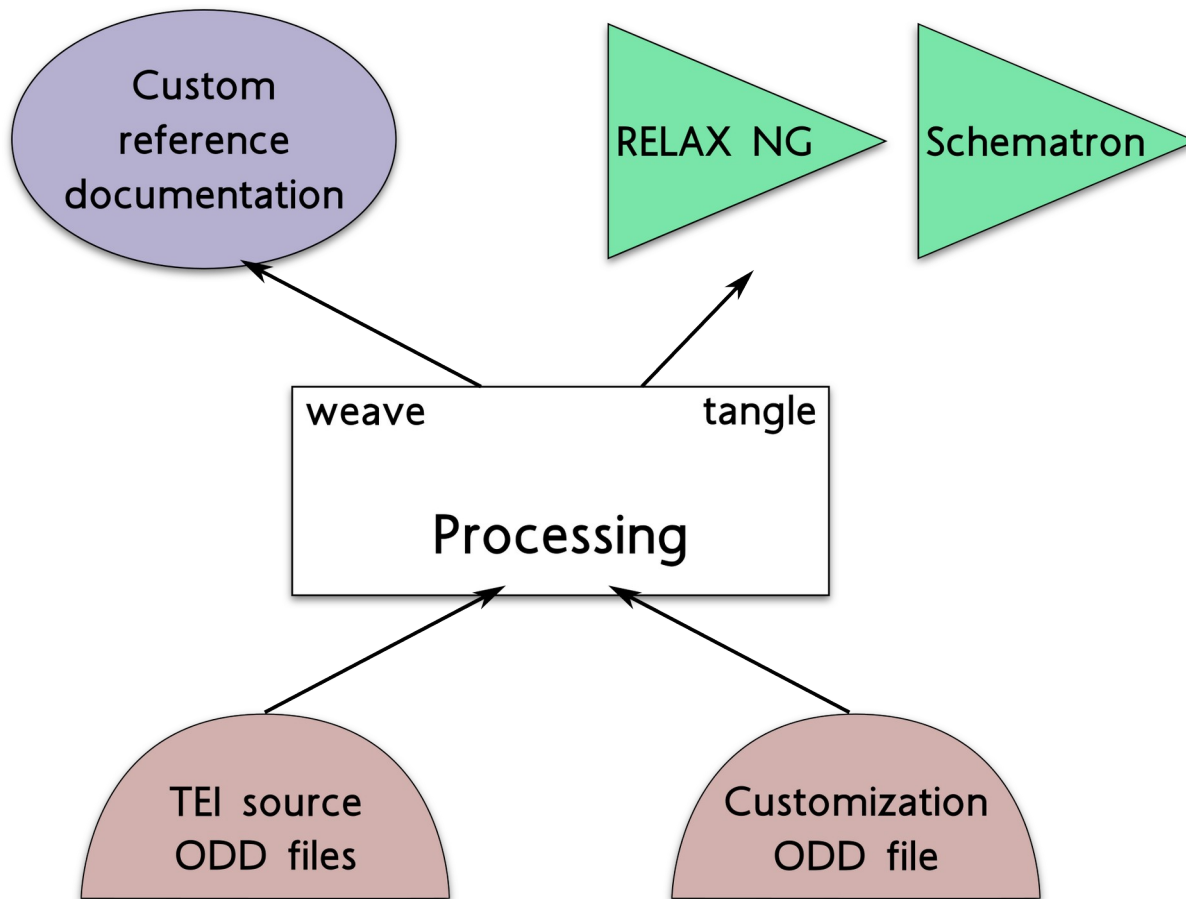
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Outline

- How TEI ODD Works
- Terminology
- The original ODD conception
- Problems with that:
 - Non-TEI markup languages
 - Current Stylesheets behaviour
 - ODD chaining
- Proposed solution

How TEI ODD Works



Terminology

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- **Derived ODD** — The result of a derivation process by which a customization ODD is processed against a base ODD. A derived ODD should not have any references to any base ODDs via @source on <*Spec> elements. It may be used as the base ODD for a subsequent chained derivation step. These have been called “compiled”, “expanded”, or “processed” ODDs.

Requirement and Intended Solution

ODD processing software needs to know whether an input ODD should be read as an original base ODD or as a customization ODD

The original plan (as we understand it) was that:

- A customization ODD would have a `<schemaSpec>` element
- An original base ODD would not

Thus software should be able to differentiate based on a simple XPath

Famous Last Words

That (simple XPath) method will not work because

- People have created stand-alone (i.e., non-TEI) markup languages using an ODD *with* a `<schemaSpec>`
 - As long as there are no `<*Ref>` elements that point at TEI, it makes no difference
- A derived ODD has a `<schemaSpec>` element, and thus looks like a customization, even though it could be a base ODD when chaining
- In order to chain efficiently, we would like any ODD file (whether a base or customization ODD) to be usable as a base

Current Processing

```
<xsl:function name="atop:is-base-odd" as="xs:boolean">
  <xsl:param name="pOdd" as="node()"/>
  <xsl:choose>
    <!--If no schemaSpec exists, it's base (e.g. p5subset).-->
    <xsl:when test="not( $pOdd/descendant::schemaSpec )">
      <xsl:sequence select="true()"/>
    </xsl:when>
    <!--If any *Ref element child of schemaSpec has @key, we can assume that it's a customization.-->
    <xsl:when test="
      some $r in $pOdd/descendant::schemaSpec/child::*[ ends-with(local-name(), 'Ref') ]
      satisfies $r/@key">
      <xsl:sequence select="false()"/>
    </xsl:when>
    <!--Any *Spec element with a mode attribute not equal to "add" means it must be a customization.-->
    <xsl:when test="
      some $s in $pOdd/descendant::schemaSpec/child::*[ ends-with(local-name(), 'Spec') ]
      satisfies $s/@mode = ('delete', 'change', 'replace')">
      <xsl:sequence select="false()"/>
    </xsl:when>
    <xsl:otherwise>
      <xsl:sequence select="true()"/>
    </xsl:otherwise>
  </xsl:choose>
</xsl:function>
```

Proposed Solution

1. Make the @source of <schemaSpec> a required attribute
 - a. This means that "tei:current" is no longer a *default*, but it is still available
2. Create a special-purpose value (e.g. "tei:none") for use when the ODD is a base ODD

This is not a backwards-compatible change, but in the vast majority of cases the fix would be to add source="tei:X.Y.Z" and in the remaining few source="tei:none", either of which is trivial to do.

Thank you! — see <https://github.com/TEIC/TEI/issues/2591>

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Questions?